

Elegy of the Rhine

O you River Rhine
Who lay low on that summer day
We thought for centuries
You'd be here to stay

Alas, were the skies
So grim and so grey
And yet not a drop
Would from any cloud stray

The banks now stretched
Into the bed ever sear
So the boats once unceasing
Shall come nevermore here

The cruise forever docked
Retired and derelict
Under the eye of the colossus
At his lifeless Deutsches Eck

The castles yet loom
Defunct and inert
Once faithful guardians
Now kings of only dirt

O Rhine, how lovely was it then
Fore the Earth was scorched by thunder
Ere you shed your last tear
When the world went under